



HAORAN ZHENG

AI RESEARCHER

✉ haoranzheng@uchicago.edu

📍 Chicago, IL, USA

ABOUT ME

Current Pre-Doctoral Fellow at UChicago Booth in Quantitative Marketing with Professor Andreas Kraft.
Graduated with M.S. in Data Science from The University of Chicago with a 4.0 GPA. Earned bachelor's degrees in Economics, Finance, and History as a triple major at The Ohio State University.
Experienced in teaching roles across STEM fields, including Statistics.
Recipient of the Pace Setters Award.

PUBLICATIONS

When to Think Fast and Slow? AMOR: Adaptive Entropy Gate for Hybrid Models

Under review · ICLR 2027

Conceptizer: Next-Token Prediction Is Not All You Need

To be submitted · ACL Rolling Review

Does Listing Text Predict Prices in the Age of AI?

Working paper · preprint forthcoming

Do AIs Dream of Electric Butterflies? Benchmarking LLM Consciousness via Theory-Grounded Self-Reports

PsyArXiv preprint · Oct 2025

SCENE: Evaluating Explainable AI Techniques Using Soft Counterfactuals

arXiv preprint · Aug 2024

LINKS

Personal Website:

haoranzhengraul.github.io

LinkedIn Profile:

linkedin.com/in/haoran-zheng-04a9551ba

WORK EXPERIENCE

Dr. Andreas Kraft

The University of Chicago
Booth School of Business
Jun 2025 – Present

Dr. Nicholas Epley

The University of Chicago
Booth School of Business
Sep 2024 – Jun 2025

Mindworks Lab

The University of Chicago
Booth School of Business
Apr 2024 – Jun 2025

Dr. Christopher Reed

The Ohio State University
Apr 2024 – May 2025

China Automotive Systems

NASDAQ: CAAS
May 2021 – May 2023

The Ohio State University

Feb 2021 – May 2022

Research Professional in Quantitative Marketing

- Working on fuel-market research and related projects, including geolocating gas stations relative to highways, designing a simulated eBay-style marketplace, finding new datasets for potential research, and cleaning, labeling and analyzing data.

Research Assistant in Behavioral Science

- Collaborated closely with Dr. Nicholas Epley and Yale PhD candidate Yin Li on "The Multicultural Study," focusing on cross-cultural perceptions of beliefs and preferences.

Research Specialist in Behavioral Science

- Examined frontier behavioral science research on prospect theory and diminishing sensitivity.
- Co-managed studies and collected data for Dr. Alexander Todorov and Dr. Sarah Sebo.

Research Assistant in History

- Applied modern NLP techniques and the SCENE method to traditional history research.
- Identified the significance of previously unseen historical documents.

Financial Analyst

- Conducted financial analysis and modeling for automotive industry applications.

Lead Teaching Assistant for Statistics 2320

- Taught two weekly recitations for 65 students each, focusing on statistical concepts and analytical tools (R).
- Developed customized review notes and visual aids for 900+ enrolled students each semester.

EDUCATION

The University of Chicago

Chicago, IL
2024

The Ohio State University

Columbus, OH
2022

Master of Science in Data Science

- Thesis: "Demystifying the Black Box: Evaluations of Explainable AI Techniques in NLP" (Advisor: Dr. Utku Pamuksuz).

Bachelor of Science in Economics

- Triple major in Economics (GPA 3.9/4.0), Finance (GPA 3.8/4.0), and History (GPA 3.8/4.0).

ACTIVITIES

- Soccer: played for the Columbus Crew (Major League Soccer) reserve team, 2016–17 season.
- E-sports: competed professionally in Pro Evolution Soccer 2017; ranked 45th on the American continental server; semifinalist at the US National Championship; YouTube channel "FlyinGodzilla."
- Muay Thai & kickboxing: sanctioned bouts (1–1 record).
- Photography.